



English — Cbse English Language & Literature — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. The question paper has five sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D & E (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Sections D-E assess the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.
4. Marks for each question are indicated against it.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A — Reading Attempt all 2 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s).		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
1	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Plastic We Cannot See Plastic pollution is often imagined as bottles floating on rivers or bags tangled in branches, but the most pervasive form of plastic waste is one we rarely notice. Microplastics — fragments smaller than five millimetres — have quietly spread through nearly every corner of the natural world. They originate from the breakdown of larger plastic items, synthetic textile fibres shed during washing, and microbeads once common in cosmetics. Because they are too small to be filtered out by most wastewater systems, they slip into rivers, oceans, and farmland almost unnoticed. Once microplastics enter water bodies, they are ingested by fish, plankton, and other aquatic organisms. From there, they travel up the food chain, eventually reaching the seafood on our plates. Agricultural soil is another major sink. When sewage sludge is used as fertiliser, the plastic particles it carries settle into the ground, where they can be absorbed by crops. Scientists have even detected microplastics in table salt, honey, and drinking water. The human health effects are still being studied, but early research suggests that these particles can accumulate in organs and may cause inflammation. What makes microplastics particularly troubling is their persistence. Unlike organic matter, they do not biodegrade; they simply fragment into ever smaller pieces. A single synthetic garment can release thousands of fibres in one wash cycle. These fibres are so fine that standard washing-machine filters cannot trap them. The result is a slow, invisible accumulation in the environment that no single cleanup effort can reverse. Despite the scale of the problem, individual choices do matter. Choosing clothing made from natural fibres like cotton or wool reduces fibre shedding. Refusing single-use plastics, carrying reusable bags, and buying unpackaged produce cut down the volume of plastic that eventually fragments. Installing a microfiber filter on washing machines, though not yet mandatory, can capture a significant share of fibres before they reach drains. Supporting policies that ban unnecessary microbeads and push for better waste-water treatment is equally important. Microplastics may be invisible to the naked eye, but their presence is a visible reminder of how deeply consumer habits shape the planet. The solution is not a single dramatic gesture but a sustained shift in everyday behaviour — one wash, one purchase, one refusal at a time. (i) Which of the following is NOT mentioned in the passage as a source of microplastics? [1 mark(s)] (A) Breakdown of larger plastic items (B) Synthetic textile fibres shed during washing (C) Natural fibres like cotton and wool (D) Microbeads once common in cosmetics Ans: C	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>The passage lists the breakdown of larger items, synthetic textile fibres, and microbeads as sources of microplastics. Cotton and wool are mentioned later as natural-fibre alternatives that reduce shedding, not as sources.</i> (ii) What can be inferred about most wastewater systems from the passage? [1 mark(s)] (A) They convert microplastics into harmless organic matter. (B) They are designed to filter out microplastics efficiently. (C) They are the sole cause of microplastic pollution in oceans. (D) They are unable to remove microplastic particles before they reach natural water bodies. Ans: D <i>The passage states that microplastics are 'too small to be filtered out by most wastewater systems' and therefore 'slip into rivers, oceans, and farmland', implying these systems cannot effectively remove them.</i> (iii) The word 'pervasive' in paragraph 1 most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Harmless to humans (B) Widespread and difficult to avoid (C) Recently discovered (D) Visible and large in size Ans: B <i>In context, the passage describes microplastics as having 'spread through nearly every corner of the natural world', which aligns with the meaning of 'pervasive' as widespread and difficult to avoid.</i> (iv) The passage suggests that microplastics are particularly difficult to manage because: [1 mark(s)] (A) They do not biodegrade and simply fragment into smaller pieces. (B) They dissolve completely in seawater. (C) They can be easily filtered by standard washing machines. (D) They are produced only in laboratories. Ans: A <i>Paragraph 3 explicitly states that microplastics 'do not biodegrade' and 'simply fragment into ever smaller pieces', making their accumulation slow and difficult to reverse.</i> (v) The author's overall stance in the passage is best described as: [1 mark(s)] (A) Cautiously optimistic that individual and policy-level actions can reduce the problem. (B) Completely hopeless about the microplastic crisis. (C) Critical of agricultural practices alone. (D) Indifferent to the environmental impact of consumer habits. Ans: A <i>The passage acknowledges the scale of the problem but argues that 'individual choices do matter' and recommends both personal actions and policy support, reflecting a cautiously optimistic stance.</i> (vi) How do microplastics enter agricultural soil, according to the passage? [1 mark(s)]	



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	Ans: When sewage sludge is used as fertiliser, the plastic particles it carries settle into the ground. <i>The passage states that agricultural soil is a major sink for microplastics because sewage sludge used as fertiliser carries plastic particles that settle into the ground.</i> (vii) Why does the author describe microplastics as 'invisible to the naked eye' yet still a 'visible reminder'? [1 mark(s)] Ans: They are too small to see directly, but their widespread presence in nature clearly shows the impact of consumer habits on the planet. <i>The author uses this contrast to show that although microplastics cannot be seen individually, their detection across soil, water, and food makes the environmental consequences of everyday consumption plainly evident.</i> (viii) Which word used in the passage means 'to gradually gather or build up over time'? [1 mark(s)] Ans: accumulate <i>The passage states that microplastic particles 'can accumulate in organs', using the word 'accumulate' to mean gradually gathering or building up.</i> (ix) Explain how the passage links everyday consumer choices to the microplastic problem and suggests solutions at both individual and policy levels. [2 mark(s)] Ans: The passage links consumer habits such as washing synthetic clothes, using single-use plastics, and buying packaged goods to the creation of microplastics. At the individual level, it suggests choosing natural-fibre clothing, refusing single-use plastics, and installing microfiber filters. At the policy level, it recommends banning unnecessary microbeads and improving wastewater treatment. <i>The passage first connects daily activities to microplastic generation and then presents a two-tier solution: personal actions like clothing and purchasing choices, and systemic actions like policy bans and improved wastewater infrastructure.</i>	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
2	<i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i> The Empty Nest The house had always been a restless thing, alive with the clatter of sneakers on the staircase and the steady hum of the television drifting up from the living room. Now, as Mira stood in the doorway of her daughter's room, the silence felt almost solid, like a held breath waiting to be released. The posters had been taken down carefully, leaving faint rectangles of brighter paint on the walls — ghostly frames of a childhood that had quietly slipped away. On the desk sat a single hairpin, overlooked in the careful packing. Mira picked it up and turned it between her fingers, feeling its familiar weight. It was a small thing, yet it held the warmth of hurried mornings and the scent of jasmine shampoo. She wondered how so many years had folded into a single afternoon of suitcases and last instructions. She remembered the first day of school, a tiny hand gripping hers, then slowly letting go. She remembered the scraped knees, the whispered secrets, the slammed doors of adolescence. Every stage had been a rehearsal for this final departure, though she had never quite believed it would arrive. Downstairs, a horn honked twice. Her daughter called out, "Maa, I'll be fine!" The words were light, almost breezy, but they carried the weight of a promise. Mira smiled, though her eyes glistened. She placed the hairpin on the windowsill and walked down to the gate. The empty nest was not an ending; it was simply the space where love learned to fly without a net. (i) What does the silence in Mira's daughter's room feel like to her? [1 mark(s)] (A) Almost solid, like a held breath waiting to be released (B) A peaceful calm after years of noise (C) A welcome relief from constant chaos (D) An unfamiliar and frightening presence Ans: A <i>The passage directly states that the silence 'felt almost solid, like a held breath waiting to be released,' capturing Mira's emotional weight of the moment.</i> (ii) What does Mira's act of placing the hairpin on the windowsill instead of keeping it most likely signify? [1 mark(s)] (A) She no longer cares about small mementos of her daughter (B) She is accepting the departure rather than clinging to the past (C) She plans to pack it carefully for the next trip (D) She is angry at being left behind in the house Ans: B <i>The passage shows Mira acknowledging the hairpin's emotional value but choosing to leave it behind as she walks down to the gate, which suggests she is accepting her daughter's departure rather than holding on.</i> (iii) The word 'glistened' as used in the passage most nearly means: [1 mark(s)] (A) Dried up and became rough	10



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	(B) Closed tightly and firmly (C) Shone with a sparkling, wet light (D) Turned red with sudden anger Ans: C <i>The passage describes Mira smiling while her eyes 'glistened,' indicating they shone with unshed tears — a sparkling, moist brightness.</i> (iv) What does the forgotten hairpin symbolise for Mira? [1 mark(s)] Ans: It symbolises memories of her daughter's childhood — hurried mornings and jasmine-scented shampoo — a small remnant of a life that has moved on. <i>The passage links the hairpin to 'the warmth of hurried mornings and the scent of jasmine shampoo,' making it a token of everyday life that has now slipped away.</i> (v) Why does the author describe every stage of growing up as a 'rehearsal for this final departure'? [1 mark(s)] Ans: Each stage involved increasing independence and separation, gradually preparing both mother and daughter for the ultimate moment of leaving home. <i>The passage lists milestones — the first day of school, scraped knees, slammed doors — each showing a step toward independence, making them practice for the final leave-taking.</i> (vi) How does the final sentence redefine the idea of the 'empty nest'? What does it suggest about parental love? [2 mark(s)] Ans: The final sentence reframes the empty nest not as a loss or ending but as a space where love learns to let go and trust the child's independence. It suggests that parental love ultimately means allowing the child to fly freely, even without the safety net of constant presence. <i>The passage concludes that 'the empty nest was not an ending; it was simply the space where love learned to fly without a net,' presenting letting go as an act of love rather than loss.</i>	
Section B — Writing Attempt 2 out of 2.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 45, Rose Garden Road, Chandigarh. Your cousin Siddharth/Sneha, who lives in Delhi, has not visited your family for over a year. Write a letter to him/her inviting him/her to spend the summer holidays with your family. In your letter you may touch upon the following cues: • A family trip to Shimla planned for the first week of June • Your grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June • How long it has been since you last met and how much everyone misses him/her Word limit: 100-150 words. <i>(Word limit: 100-150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 45, Rose Garden Road Chandigarh 20 May 2025 Dear Siddharth, I hope this letter finds you in great spirits! It has been so long since we last met, and I really miss the fun times we shared during Diwali. Everyone here misses you terribly. I am writing to invite you to spend the summer holidays with us in Chandigarh. We have planned a week-long trip to Shimla in the first week of June, and it would be wonderful if you could join us. The cool weather there will be a perfect escape from the heat. Also, Daadi's seventy-fifth birthday falls on the fifteenth of June, and the whole family is gathering to celebrate. She keeps asking about you and would be thrilled to see you. Do pack some warm clothes for Shimla. Let me know your travel dates soon so we can book the tickets together. Everyone here is eager to see you! Yours lovingly, Aarav • Express how long it has been since the last meeting and that the family misses the cousin • Invite the cousin to spend the summer holidays with the family in Chandigarh • Mention the planned week-long family trip to Shimla in the first week of June • Inform about grandmother's 75th birthday celebration in mid-June and that she is eager to see the cousin • Ask the cousin to share travel dates so tickets can be booked together • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Paragraph Write a paragraph in 90–130 words on My Best Friend. You may use the following cues: • Introduce your best friend (name, how you met) and describe their appearance and personality. • Mention shared interests and one occasion when your friend supported you. • Explain why this friendship matters to you. <i>(Word limit: 90–130 words; Suggested time: 15 min)</i> Model Answer: A true friend is a rare blessing, and I am fortunate to have found one in Aarav Sharma. We met in Class 6 during a science project, and our bond has grown stronger since. Aarav is tall, cheerful, and always ready with an encouraging smile. What sets him apart is his unwavering honesty — he tells me when I am wrong, yet with kindness. He balances academics with basketball, and his discipline motivates me to improve. We share a love for mystery novels and discuss plots for hours. When I struggled with mathematics last year, he patiently tutored me without making me feel small. Our friendship matters because it is built on trust, respect, and genuine care. Aarav makes me a better person, and I cherish every moment together. • Introduce the best friend by name and describe how the friendship began • Describe the friend's appearance and key personality traits such as honesty, cheerfulness, and discipline • Mention shared interests and an occasion when the friend offered support during a difficult time • Explain why the friendship matters — built on trust, respect, and mutual growth • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation / Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar Accuracy: 1 mark(s)	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
4	Formal Letter You are Vihaan/Mehul Kapoor, a resident of 27, Green Park Avenue, Indore. On 5 May 2025 you purchased a TurboChef 28L Microwave Oven (Model TC-28L, Serial No. 88412, Lot No. TC-28L-0425) from Sunrise Electronics, an authorised dealer of TurboChef Appliances India Pvt. Ltd. After just ten days of normal use the oven stopped heating, though the turntable and display still work. The product carries a one-year warranty. Write a formal letter to the Customer Service Manager, TurboChef Appliances India Pvt. Ltd., 4th Floor, Tower B, Mumbai requesting a free replacement. Your letter must cover the following points: • Full product details: model, serial number, lot number, date and place of purchase. • Nature of the defect and when it appeared. • Mention of attached invoice and warranty card. • A constructive suggestion: request the company to conduct a quality check on the entire batch (Lot No. TC-28L-0425) to prevent similar failures for other customers. Word limit: 100–150 words (body only). <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 27, Green Park Avenue Indore – 452001 15 May 2025 The Customer Service Manager TurboChef Appliances India Pvt. Ltd. 4th Floor, Tower B Mumbai – 400001 Subject: Request for replacement of defective TurboChef 28L Microwave Oven (Model TC-28L, Serial No. 88412) Sir/Madam, I am writing to report a defect in a TurboChef 28L Microwave Oven (Model TC-28L, Serial No. 88412, Lot No. TC-28L-0425) that I purchased on 5 May 2025 from your authorised dealer, Sunrise Electronics, Indore. The appliance worked normally for the first ten days, but on 16 May it stopped heating entirely while the turntable and display continued to function. I have attached a copy of the original invoice and the warranty card for your reference. Since the product failed well within the one-year warranty period, I request a free replacement at the earliest. Additionally, I would like to suggest that your quality team inspect the entire batch bearing lot number TC-28L-0425, as a similar issue could affect other customers and damage the reputation of your brand. I trust you will treat this matter with urgency and look forward to a prompt resolution. Yours faithfully,	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Mehul Kapoor • State full product details: model TC-28L, serial number 88412, lot number TC-28L-0425, date 5 May 2025, purchased from Sunrise Electronics, Indore. • Describe the defect: oven stopped heating after ten days of normal use while turntable and display still function. • Mention that the invoice and warranty card are attached. • Request a free replacement under the one-year warranty. • Suggest that the company conduct a quality check on the entire batch (Lot No. TC-28L-0425) to prevent similar issues for other customers. • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s) OR Informal Letter You are Aarav/Ananya, a Class 9 student living at 27, Lotus Colony, Jaipur. Your younger brother Vihaan, who studies in Class 7 at a boarding school in Ajmer, has been spending too much time on his phone playing games and watching videos. His recent test scores have dropped, and your parents are worried. Write a letter to Vihaan advising him on how to balance his studies and screen time. In your letter you may include: • your concern about his excessive phone use and falling grades • practical tips to limit screen time and improve study habits • an encouraging note or incentive to motivate him <i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i> Model Answer: 27, Lotus Colony Jaipur 15 May 2025 Dear Vihaan, I was happy to see you last weekend, but I noticed you were constantly on your phone, even during lunch! Mom mentioned your test scores have dropped this term, and I think excessive screen time is the reason. I know games and videos are fun, but too much of anything is harmful. Here is what I suggest: set a daily limit of one hour for phone entertainment. Use a timer if needed. Keep your phone away during study hours and meals. Try studying in focused sessions of thirty minutes with short breaks. Also, spend more time outdoors — cricket or cycling will refresh your mind far better than scrolling. I follow this routine myself, and it really works. If you improve your grades next term, I will take you to that gaming cafe you love. You are bright and capable — just channel your energy wisely!	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Your loving brother, Aarav • Express concern about younger sibling's excessive screen time and dropping test scores • Suggest setting a daily one-hour limit for phone entertainment with a timer • Advise keeping the phone away during study hours and meals • Recommend focused thirty-minute study sessions with short breaks and outdoor activities • Offer an encouraging incentive (gaming cafe trip) for improving grades next term • Format: 1 mark(s) • Content: 2 mark(s) • Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s) • Spelling & Grammar: 1 mark(s)	
Section C – Grammar Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
5	Do not touch the exhibits in the museum. [Active & Passive Voice] (A) Let not the exhibits in the museum be touched. (B) The exhibits in the museum not be touched. (C) Let the exhibits in the museum being not touched. (D) Let the exhibits in the museum not be touched. Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? A negative imperative sentence is converted using 'Let + object + not + be + V3'. The correct form is 'Let the exhibits in the museum not be touched'. 'Let not the exhibits...' places 'not' in the wrong position, 'The exhibits... not be touched' omits 'Let', and 'being not touched' uses 'being' instead of 'be'.	1
6	One of the scientists who ___ the vaccine was honoured with a prestigious award. [Subject-Verb Concord] (A) has discovered (B) discovered (C) discovers (D) was discovered Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? In the relative clause 'who ___ the vaccine', the relative pronoun 'who' refers to 'scientists', which is plural. Therefore, the verb in the relative clause must be plural. 'Discovered' is the correct plural past form. 'Has discovered' and 'discovers' are singular, and 'was discovered' changes the voice from active to passive, altering the meaning.	1
7	She spoke as if she ___ an expert on the subject. [Clauses] (A) was (B) is (C) were (D) has been	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? After 'as if' describing an unreal or imaginary situation, the subjunctive 'were' is used for all subjects. 'Was' is the indicative form and is incorrect in formal usage for hypothetical comparisons. 'Is' and 'has been' do not match the unreal meaning conveyed by 'as if.'	
8	Iron is more useful than any other metal. [Sentence Transformation] (A) No other metal is as useful as iron. (B) No other metal is more useful than iron. (C) Iron is as useful as any other metal. (D) Very few metals are as useful as iron. Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? When converting from comparative ('more useful than any other') to positive degree, we use 'No other...as...as' structure. 'Iron is more useful than any other metal' becomes 'No other metal is as useful as iron.' Option B reverses the meaning, option C suggests equality rather than superiority, and option D uses 'Very few' which would correspond to 'one of the most useful', not 'more useful than any other'.	1
9	Each of the participants who completed the marathon ____ a certificate of achievement. [Gap Filling] (A) receives (B) receive (C) were given (D) is receiving Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? The true grammatical subject is 'Each,' which is always singular, even though 'participants' is the noun closest to the verb. A singular subject requires a singular verb, so 'receives' is correct. 'Receive' is a plural verb form, 'were given' is also plural, and 'is receiving' shifts the aspect to present continuous, which does not suit the context of a completed event.	1
10	They postponed ____ the annual function due to unforeseen circumstances that arose at the last moment. [Participles & Gerunds] (A) to hold (B) holding (C) hold (D) to holding Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? The verb 'postpone' is a transitive verb that takes a gerund as its direct object, so 'holding' is correct. 'To hold' and 'to holding' incorrectly insert 'to', and the base form 'hold' cannot follow 'postponed' directly.	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
11	The strict librarian did not let the students ___ more than three reference books at a time during the examination period. [Non-Finite Verbs] (A) to borrow (B) borrowing (C) borrow (D) borrowed Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? The verb 'let' is a causative verb that takes a bare infinitive (base form without 'to'), so 'borrow' is correct. 'To borrow' incorrectly adds the infinitive marker after 'let'. 'Borrowing' is a gerund/participle form, and 'borrowed' is a past participle; neither is grammatical after 'let' in this structure.	1
12	Extreme weather conditions ___ disrupt flight schedules, causing inconvenience to hundreds of passengers. [Modals] (A) might (B) ought (C) would (D) can Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? 'Can' expresses a general or theoretical possibility — that extreme weather is capable of causing such disruption. 'Might' suggests a much weaker, more remote possibility than the factual tone of the sentence warrants. 'Ought' requires 'to' before the main verb and expresses moral duty, not possibility. 'Would' needs a conditional context (an if-clause) to convey possibility.	1
13	In the sentence "The scientist explained how [Direct & Indirect Objects] (A) the vaccine (B) the immune system (C) how the vaccine stimulates the immune system to produce antibodies (D) antibodies Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? The entire noun clause 'how the vaccine stimulates the immune system to produce antibodies' answers the question 'explained what?' and therefore functions as the direct object. It cannot be reduced to a single noun within the clause; the whole subordinate clause fills the object slot. 'The vaccine', 'the immune system', and 'antibodies' are nouns inside the noun clause, not the direct object of 'explained'.	1
14	The exhibition is being inaugurated by the chief guest tomorrow, ___ [Question Tags] (A) doesn't it (B) isn't it (C) wasn't it (D) hasn't it Answer: Correct Option: (B)	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The statement is positive and uses the passive continuous auxiliary 'is being', so the tag repeats the 'be' auxiliary with negative polarity: 'isn't it'. 'Doesn't it' wrongly uses 'do' instead of the existing 'be' auxiliary, 'wasn't it' mismatches the tense, and 'hasn't it' uses the wrong auxiliary entirely.	
Section D — Literature (Short Answer) Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).		
15	Do you think Ravi's mother will get to know about what had happened? Answer: Yes, Ravi's mother will most likely get to know about what happened. When she asked what they did that day, Grandpa coolly replied that Ravi had "disappeared instead of staying at home" to look after him, which directly reveals that Ravi did not fulfill his responsibility. Furthermore, Grandpa had a gift-wrapped parcel for Ravi, which indicates he had gone out and purchased something. This would naturally raise questions from Ravi's mother about how Grandpa went out alone when she had strictly instructed Ravi not to let him go out on his own. Ravi's confused and embarrassed reaction would also make his mother suspicious, making it difficult for him to hide the truth. ► Why? The textbook context clearly shows that Grandpa has already hinted at the truth by telling Ravi's mother that Ravi 'disappeared.' Additionally, the gift-wrapped parcel is evidence that Grandpa went out. Ravi's embarrassed demeanor further suggests the truth will come out. Students should connect these textual details to support their inference. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify Grandpa's statement to Ravi's mother about Ravi disappearing 2. Step 2: Note the gift-wrapped parcel as evidence of Grandpa going out 3. Step 3: Consider Ravi's confused and embarrassed reaction as a sign the truth may emerge [Ch 7: Vitamin-M]	2
16	How did the last remaining leaf on the creeper bring about a change in Johnsy's attitude towards life? Answer: When Johnsy saw that the last leaf had survived the storm and fierce winds, it brought about a profound change in her. She realised how wicked she had been in wanting to die and acknowledged that she had been a bad girl who had not cooperated with Sue. The leaf's resilience taught her that it is a sin to want to die. She then accepted the hot soup Sue gave her, combed her hair, and smiled brightly, showing her renewed will to live. The doctor later confirmed that Johnsy now had the will to live and would recover soon. ► Why? The leaf's survival against the storm served as a metaphor for resilience, inspiring Johnsy to fight her illness and value life. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Describe what Johnsy observed about the leaf 2. Step 2: Explain the realisation she had about wanting to die 3. Step 3: Mention the actions that showed her changed attitude [Ch 5: Winds of Change]	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
17	A canvas is similar to a garden plot as ____. Answer: A canvas is similar to a garden plot as both serve as a space where art and life coincide. Just as a painter uses a canvas to create artwork with brushstrokes and colours, a gardener uses a plot to create nature's artwork with seeds and blossoms. The poem's line, "Each plot, a canvas wide", emphasizes this similarity. It shows that a garden plot is a medium for the gardener's creativity, much like a canvas is for a painter. Both transform a blank space into a vibrant, living masterpiece. ► Why? The poem explicitly draws this comparison in the line 'Each plot, a canvas wide, / Where art and life coincide.' By likening a plot to a canvas, the poet suggests that gardening is a form of art. A canvas provides the foundation for a painter's creation, while a garden plot provides the foundation for a gardener's creation, allowing both to bring their imaginative visions to life. [Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]	2
18	Sentila observes her mother making pots. What does this tell us about her? Answer: Sentila observing her mother making pots reveals her deep fascination and secret passion for the craft. Even though her mother wanted her to become a weaver, Sentila quietly dreamed of being a pot maker. Her careful observation shows her attentiveness and eagerness to learn. By closely watching how her mother held the spatula, slackened the rhythm while fashioning the mouth, and added dough for the rim, Sentila silently mastered the technique. When she finally got the opportunity, she displayed the same speed and dexterity as her mother, proving her dedication. ► Why? The question asks what Sentila's observation reveals about her character. The text shows that despite her mother's opposition and preference for weaving, Sentila's observation stems from a deep, lifelong fascination. Her observation is not passive; it is an active learning process. She pays close attention to specific techniques (holding the spatula, shaping the mouth, adding the rim), which allows her to replicate her mother's speed and dexterity when she finally attempts it herself, proving her dedication and natural aptitude. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify Sentila's hidden passion and fascination for pot making despite her mother's wishes. 2. Step 2: Explain how her keen observation translates into learning the craft's techniques and demonstrating great skill and dexterity when given the chance. [Ch 3: The Pot Maker]	2
19	Speaker — Who appears to be the speaker and what is her/his role here?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The speaker appears to be a keen observer and an appreciative listener of the working class. She/he closely observes the everyday workers, such as the boatmen, shoemakers, cooks, designers, and masons, finding music and rhythm in their labour. The speaker's role here is to act as a celebrator of these varied vocations. By declaring, "I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied voices I hear!", the speaker emphasizes that the voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity. She/he brings attention to the dignity of their work, ensuring their contributions are recognized and valued in society. ► Why? The question asks about the speaker in the poem. Based on the provided context, the poem's narrator hears the sounds of various workers (boatmen, shoemakers, cook, designer, mason) and identifies these sounds as celebrations of their identity. The speaker's role is to observe these varied voices and celebrate them, summarizing the core theme that one's vocation is one's identity. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the speaker's persona based on the poem's lines like 'I hear Bharat celebrating, the varied voices I hear!', which indicates an observer. 2. Step 2: Determine the speaker's role by analyzing how they perceive the workers' sounds as 'delicious singing' and 'rhythm', acting as a celebrator of their identity. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	
20	How do they spend their time? How do you spend time with them? Answer: The grandmother spends her time cooking and feeding her grandchildren, which brings her immense happiness. She also enjoys discussing the latest episode of a story with her friends, often engaging in debates about it. The narrator spends time with her by attending weddings in the neighbouring village with cousins, where they eat and play endlessly, enjoying their freedom. When at home, the narrator interacts with her affectionately, calling her Avva, and checks on her well-being, especially when she finds her in tears after returning from a week-long trip. ► Why? The question is from the 'Reflect and Respond' section but asks about the characters based on the provided context. The context clearly states how the grandmother (Avva) spends her time—cooking, feeding grandchildren, and discussing story episodes with friends. It also details how the narrator (the student/author) spends time with her—going to weddings, playing with cousins, and interacting with her affectionately at home. [Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]	2
21	What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'?	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The refrain 'she's peerless, let's praise her!' has a strong impact as it reinforces the central theme of the poem—India's unmatched greatness. By repeatedly asserting that the country is peerless, the poet emphasizes that India's natural beauty, spiritual heritage, and historical greatness have no equal anywhere on earth. Furthermore, the refrain creates a chant-like rhythm that adds to the lyrical quality of the poem. It acts as a powerful, unifying conclusion to the lists of India's glories, such as the mighty Himavant, the generous Ganga, and the sacred Upanishads. Ultimately, it evokes a deep sense of admiration and pride, urging everyone to celebrate and honour this unparalleled land. ► Why? The question asks for the impact of the refrain. The context shows the refrain is a repeated assertion of India being 'peerless' (unmatched) and a call to 'praise' her. It ties together the examples of India's greatness (Himavant, Ganga, Upanishads, etc.) mentioned in the stanzas. The context also mentions the poem has a 'measured, chant-like rhythm' and a tone of 'admiration and pride', which the refrain helps to build. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	
22	The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem. Answer: Two examples of adjective-noun collocations from the poem are gold medals and beaming faces. In the phrase gold medals, the word 'gold' acts as an adjective modifying the noun 'medals', indicating the type or colour of the medals. Similarly, in beaming faces, the present participle 'beaming' functions as an adjective describing the noun 'faces', showing the athletes' joy. Other valid examples from the poem include young boy and Special Olympics. In young boy, the adjective 'young' describes the noun 'boy', and in Special Olympics, the adjective 'Special' modifies the proper noun 'Olympics'. ► Why? An adjective-noun collocation is a pair of words where an adjective habitually modifies a noun. In the poem's final stanza, 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces' perfectly fit this criterion, as 'gold' describes the medals and 'beaming' describes the faces. Other acceptable pairs from the provided text include 'young boy' and 'Special Olympics'. ► Step-by-step: - Step 1: Understand that an adjective-noun collocation consists of an adjective modifying a noun that habitually appears together. - Step 2: Scan the poem lines provided in the context for adjective-noun pairs (e.g., in the line 'with nine gold medals' and 'nine beaming faces'). - Step 3: Identify two clear examples, such as 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces', and explain how the adjective modifies the noun in each pair. [Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
23	Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect. (i) In the 2016 Rio Paralympic Games, I secured the silver medal in the shot-put event. (ii) I feel it was a moment of personal victory and a step forward in changing perceptions. Answer: The given statements display a fact-opinion relationship. Statement (i) states that the speaker secured the silver medal in the shot-put event at the 2016 Rio Paralympic Games. This is a fact because it is a verifiable piece of information that can be proven true with records. Statement (ii) expresses the speaker's opinion about that event. The phrase "I feel" clearly indicates that it is her personal belief or perception that the victory was a step forward in changing perceptions, rather than an objective effect. ► Why? The textbook context defines a fact as 'evidence/factual information that can be proved to be true' and an opinion as 'writer's beliefs/perception'. Statement (i) is a verifiable fact about winning a medal. Statement (ii) starts with 'I feel', marking it as a personal opinion or belief about the significance of that fact. Therefore, the relationship is fact-opinion, not cause-effect. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Analyze statement (i) - 'secured the silver medal' is a historical, verifiable event, making it a fact. 2. Step 2: Analyze statement (ii) - 'I feel' indicates a personal belief or perception, making it an opinion. 3. Step 3: Conclude the relationship - Since the first statement is a fact and the second is an opinion, the pair displays a fact-opinion relationship. [Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]	2
24	How could the poet feel his mother's presence, even though she isn't there? Answer: The poet feels his mother's presence through his senses, which activate memories of her during everyday moments. Even though she is not physically there, certain experiences deeply remind him of her. He feels her presence auditorily when a tune of a song she used to hum while rocking his cradle hovers over his playthings. He also senses her olfactorily when the smell of shiuli flowers and the scent of the morning service in the temple come to him as the scent of his mother. Finally, he feels her presence visually when he looks into the distant sky and feels the stillness of his mother's gaze spreading all over the sky. ► Why? The question asks how the poet feels his mother's presence despite her absence. The context poem by Rabindranath Tagore reveals that the poet relies on his three senses: hearing (auditory), smell (olfactory), and sight (visual). In the first stanza, the auditory sense of a hovering tune reminds him of her. In the second, the olfactory sense of shiuli flowers and the temple service reminds him of her scent. In the third, the visual sense of looking at the distant sky makes him feel her still gaze. The answer synthesizes these three points directly from the text.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]	
Section E — Literature (Long Answer) Attempt all 4 questions. Each carries 5 mark(s).		
25	How does Subramania Bharati employ symbolism and allusion in the poem "Bharat Our Land" to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy? Explain with specific examples. Answer: In the poem "Bharat Our Land," Subramania Bharati masterfully employs symbolism and allusion to celebrate India's rich spiritual and philosophical heritage. The poet uses symbolism by associating natural and cultural elements with deeper meanings. The Himavant symbolises strength and permanence, emphasising the enduring nature of India's heritage. The Ganga symbolises purity and generosity, reflecting the noble qualities inherent in India's cultural identity. The Upanishads symbolise knowledge and enlightenment, representing India's intellectual and philosophical core. The "sunny golden land" symbolises richness and glory, portraying India as a land of extraordinary value. Furthermore, the poet uses allusion to deepen the poem's spiritual significance. The reference to the Upanishads alludes to ancient Indian scriptures that form the philosophical core and symbolise deep wisdom and enlightenment. The mention of Brahma-knowledge alludes to the concept of spiritual knowledge associated with self-realisation and ultimate truth, indicating that this profound wisdom has taken root in India. The reference to Buddha's dharma alludes to Gautama Buddha's teachings of compassion, non-violence, and enlightenment, highlighting India's role in shaping major religious and philosophical traditions. Together, these literary devices elevate the poem from mere description to a powerful celebration of India's peerless spiritual and philosophical legacy, reinforcing the refrain that India is unmatched and worthy of praise. ► Why? The poet uses symbolism to give deeper meaning to India's natural and cultural features, and allusion to connect the poem to India's ancient spiritual traditions, both working together to celebrate the nation's incomparable heritage. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the poem and state that the poet uses symbolism and allusion as key literary devices to celebrate India's spiritual and philosophical legacy. 2. Step 2: Explain symbolism by discussing what the Himavant (strength and permanence), Ganga (purity and generosity), Upanishads (knowledge and enlightenment), and sunny golden land (richness and glory) represent. 3. Step 3: Explain allusion by discussing the references to the Upanishads (ancient scriptures, deep wisdom), Brahma-knowledge (self-realisation, ultimate truth), and Buddha's dharma (compassion, non-violence, enlightenment). 4. Step 4: Analyse how these devices work together to reinforce the idea that India's spiritual and philosophical heritage is peerless. 5. Step 5: Conclude by connecting the use of symbolism and allusion to the refrain 'she's peerless, let's praise her!' and the overall impact of celebrating India's legacy. [Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]	5
26	What lessons can we infer from the grandmother's action of touching the narrator's feet?	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The grandmother's action of touching the narrator's feet teaches us that a teacher should be respected irrespective of gender and age. Even though the narrator was her granddaughter and much younger, the grandmother honoured her solely as a teacher, proving that the tradition of respecting a guru goes beyond age and relationships. Secondly, it highlights that there is no age bar for learning. The grandmother's determination to learn at sixty-two and her gratitude towards her teacher demonstrate that education can be pursued at any stage of life to achieve self-sufficiency and become independent. Thirdly, the action teaches the value of gratitude and humility. By touching the feet of someone younger, the grandmother sets an example that elders can also bow down to acknowledge the effort and affection of a teacher. Finally, it reinforces that respect must be given to the role of a teacher, not just to age. The grandmother believed it was her duty to respect her teacher, upholding the great tradition of honouring educators as written in the scriptures. ► Why? <i>The answer draws directly from the grandmother's dialogue and actions in the text. She explicitly states she is touching the feet of a teacher, not her granddaughter, emphasizing that respect for a teacher is irrespective of gender and age. Her determination to learn at sixty-two highlights that there is no age limit to learning. By humbling herself before her granddaughter, she demonstrates gratitude and humility, reinforcing the traditional value of respecting a guru.</i> <i>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</i>	
27	Describe the process of pot making followed by expert pot makers, as observed by Sentila. Answer: The process of pot making, as observed by Sentila, begins with gathering the raw materials. Expert potters dig grey and red clay from the riverbank using a dao and carry it back to the work shed. Next, the clay is prepared by soaking it in a trough. It is then stuffed into a bamboo cylinder in the right proportion and pounded after mixing it with water. This process turns the clay into a malleable dough. The shaping process requires great skill and coordination. The potter pushes their left hand into a lump of the softened clay and deftly rotates the lump. Simultaneously, they use a spatula held in the right hand to shape the rotating clay, creating a rhythmic tap, tap sound. For the finer details, the potter slackens the rhythm when fashioning the mouth of the pot. A strip of elongated dough is carefully added to the mouth to form the rim. Finally, after two or three days, the pots are given a final touch up to retain the required shape and to test their consistency. Once approved, the pots are taken out to dry in the sun, requiring bright sunny days to dry completely before being loaded.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer comprehensively outlines the step-by-step process of pot making as detailed in the provided text. It covers the entire journey from digging the clay at the riverbank to the final drying process, ensuring all specific techniques observed by Sentila—such as the use of the dao, the soaking and pounding of clay, the hand-spatula coordination, the addition of the rim, and the final touch-ups—are included to secure full marks for a 5-mark question. [Ch 3: The Pot Maker]	
28	The line "The voice of their vocation is the voice of their identity" carries a deep meaning about the relationship between one's work and one's self. Explain the significance of this line, discussing how different workers express their identity through their work. Answer: The line signifies that a person's vocation is not merely a means of livelihood but a profound reflection of who they are; their work gives them a unique voice and sense of self. In the poem, various workers express their identity through the distinct qualities they bring to their crafts. The craftsperson expresses their vibrant identity through fabrics woven with colours and myriad hues. The carpenters reveal their meticulous and precise nature by creating items out of wood with mathematical precision. The electricians express their purpose and identity by working with cables and wires to brighten lives. Similarly, the shoemakers affirm their identity by taking immense pride in the quality of their work, crafting footwear for feet that walk, dance, run, jump, and return home. The cook merges passion with skill, expressed through their delicious singing, while the boatmen sing while at work, telling tales of life at sea. Every worker celebrates what belongs uniquely to them and to none else. Thus, the line highlights the dignity of labour, showing that dedication to one's vocation is a direct expression of one's individuality and identity. ► Why? The question explores the central theme of the poem: the intrinsic connection between a person's vocation and their identity, emphasizing how workers inject their unique essence into their labour. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the idea that a vocation reflects a person's inner self and gives them a distinct voice in society. 2. Step 2: Explain how the craftsperson and carpenter express their identity through colours/hues and mathematical precision, respectively. 3. Step 3: Discuss the electrician's role in brightening lives and the shoemakers' pride in quality footwear for active feet returning home. 4. Step 4: Mention the cook's delicious singing and the boatmen's singing, showing how each celebrates what uniquely belongs to them. 5. Step 5: Conclude by tying these examples back to the line, affirming that one's dedication to their craft becomes their defining identity. [Ch 4: Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations]	5

